



OPERATIONS RESEARCH · FREELANCING

One year as an OR freelancer

5 honest lessons from year one



Jens-Peter Joost

Operations Research Freelancer · jpjsolutions.com

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01

Clients don't buy tech stacks. They buy **trust**.

- ✓ **Concrete industry experience** beats any tool list — 6 years in the field opens doors a CV of frameworks never will.
- ✓ **Testimonials transfer trust.** A recommendation from a happy client in a management role does the selling for you.
- ✓ **Ask the moment a project ends well.** A LinkedIn recommendation is public, hard to fake, and lowers the barrier for the next prospect.

02

Your network is your #1 source of work.

01

Personal & professional network

HIGHEST SIGNAL

Former colleagues and clients. Personal contact creates trust money can't buy — almost every project traced back here.

02

LinkedIn

LONG-TERM PLAY

A love/hate relationship — but presence compounds. Showing up consistently keeps you top of mind.

03

Freelancer platforms

LOW EFFORT, LOW YIELD

A clearly labeled OR project shows up roughly once every two months. Worth being on — don't rely on it.

03

Most of the work isn't OR — but OR is the **USP**.

The math is rarely the bottleneck. Getting the solution **applied in real life** is. That means being proficient at everything around the solver:

 **Requirements Engineering**

 **Change Management**

 **Data Validation**

 **Expectation Management**

 **Iterative Feedback Loops**

 **Software Engineering & Testing**

OR is a **small part** of the job — yet it's exactly what clients hire you for. Master the toolbox (*MIP, heuristics, CP, exact algorithms*), then everything around it.



Want the full story?

I gave a 50-minute talk on my first year as an OR freelancer. The full livestream is on YouTube.

 **Watch the recording**

youtube.com/live/ZaFQ8Z3u54o

 **Jens-Peter Joost — let's connect**

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